

L²

Launch to Lead

Mock Interview Notes

Session 3 — Behavioral Interview Practice

Session Info

Client Name

Joshua Chung

Date

03/16/2026



Target Role / Company

e.g. Software Engineer @ Deere

Question 1

Competency

Leadership & Initiative

Question

Describe a situation where you had to lead a team or project. What was your role?

STAR+2 NOTES

S — Situation

For my bridge capstone project for machine design course, we had to design, test, validate bridge (validate plastic straw truss bridge), to withstand certain load.

T — Task

I had to lead team on determining failure points. Had to determine what kind of load it could withstand before failure.

A — Action

We tested with FEA and SolidWorks simulation

R — Result

I determined that the failure point on the bridge was top left, and 5000g's before failure. Allowed us to present, and we reached a failure load similar to what I simulated. We got the bridge accurate to what was actually tested during class.

+1 — Lessons Learned

Leading group into knowing what my strategy was, to determine failure would occur due to buckling or not. Learned I have to communicate with my team well to withstand load.

+2 — If I Could Go Back

Would work with team more to break down sub tasks more for failure analysis. I should have gotten team members inputs for what they got for their failures/simulations.

Client Self-Assessment

How did the client think they did?

Coach Feedback

Used "we" and "us" a lot. Eye contact not there. Not clear on moving through STAR stages. Speak with more animation/excitement. (4 min 20 sec).



Answered the question



Addressed the competency

Rating:

0



Question 2

Competency

Problem-Solving & Technical Judgment

Question

Describe a time you improved an existing process or system.

STAR+2 NOTES

S — Situation

Was working as undergrad research assistant for robotics and AI lab. In that lab I had to design, print our robotic grippers, to test on robotic simulation systems.

T — Task

I was responsible for was to make sure that we were able to print a prototype of the robotic gripper, and have it working, and be able to implement on robotic manipulation system. Making sure our prototype came out of 3D printer correct.

A — Action

I worked on designing the robotic gripper using SolidWorks, also working with 3D pro printer, using TPU. I noticed that we had a problem with TPU straining a lot during printing. When I encountered this, made sure that the extruder temperature was on the lower end, not too hot, and fan speed was not too high second time around. Made sure every layer was sticking, not lifting off from the print bed.

R — Result

Resulted in an improvement on our robotic grippers. Allowed us to have a smoother finish on our grippers, and fully developed TPU model, prototype we could use on our systems. We were able to get good results with 1 working prototype, instead of multiple failed prototypes.

+1 — Lessons Learned

Different filaments require us to make sure configurations are correct for that filament. But for TPU, had to learn to adjust the fan speed and extruder temp to produce a part that had all layers attached together. How did you learn this??

+2 — If I Could Go Back

Would consider other filaments at that time that might be easier to print, and have less "stringing" effects or any negative effects that would impact our finish prototype result. Considering other options/filaments/3D printers to have in lab. Why didn't you do this??

Client Self-Assessment

Added transitional words for STAR framework. Mostly fit the question well, could be some improvement.

Coach Feedback

Using "kind of" a lot. Better on eye contact. Better transition through STAR areas. Process improvement came in +1 and +2, put them in the answer! Need more animation/excitement. (5 min 27sec).

☒ Answered the question ☒ Addressed the competency

Rating: 0 ★★★★★

Overall Session Notes

Strengths Observed

Josh seemed very interested in really applying my advice and feedback instantly. Made great improvement just from one question to the other. Asked very insightful questions to help him understand how to improve his performance. Seems very committed to improving.

Areas to Improve

Aside from the technical aspects of answering the STAR, +1, and +2 portions, need to work on weeding out the "ums" and "kind of"s. As well as speaking with more animation/energy/excitement. Also work on timing, and taking full advantage of 6–8 minutes of an answer.

Action Items for Client

Review notes and performance from this and from the transcript and be ready for round 2 tomorrow!